

Access to everything. Now 30% off. [Upgrade now](#)

Data Science Colle... · Following

★ Member-only story

- AI ✓
- AI Agent ✓
- Ai Engineering +
- Large Language Models +
- LLM ✓

How I'd Become an AI Engineer in 2026 (Even with No CS Degree)

The skills you need, how to learn them, and getting a job

13 min read · 6 days ago



Marina Wyss

Follow

-  Listen
-  Share
-  More



Photo by [Gery Wibowo](#) on [Unsplash](#)

This is how I'd become an AI Engineer in 2026 if I was starting from zero today. And I mean actually zero, even with no CS degree or engineering background.

I'm a Senior Applied Scientist at Twitch where I build production AI systems, and my degrees are in politics. So I got into this a weird way myself, and I've coached hundreds of folks from every kind of background into AI and ML roles.

So I know that it's possible, but only with the right strategy.

In this post, we'll go through what an AI Engineer actually does, and why the salaries are so high. Then we'll go over the skills you need, how to learn them

Welcome Offer

Access to everything. Now 30% off.
Unlock every single story.

- ✓ Read member-only stories
- ✓ Support writers you read most
- ✓ Listen to audio narrations
- ✓ Read offline with the Medium app
- ✓ Access our Mastodon community
- ✓ Connect your custom domain
- ✓ Create your own publications

Upgrade now



Following

Published in Data Science Collective

952K followers · Last published 14 hours ago

Advice, insights, and ideas from the Medium data science community



Follow

Written by Marina Wyss

15K followers · 11 following

🧠 AI explainers + tech careers without the hype. 🌱 Productivity and personal growth. 📌
www.marinawyss.com
